

Topic 6: Plant life cycles

Students should:		Guidance <i>iPrimary Curriculum reference</i>
6.1	understand that some plants have flowers that produce seeds which grow into new plants	<i>Year 6: Plant life cycles</i>
6.2	know the life cycle of a typical flowering plant, using the terms <i>germination, flowering, pollination, fertilisation</i> and <i>seed dispersal</i>	<i>Year 6: Plant life cycles</i>
6.3	explain why seeds need to be dispersed	<i>Year 6: Plant life cycles</i>
6.4	understand the conditions required for the germination of seeds	water and temperature <i>Year 6: Plant life cycles</i>
6.5	know that pollination is the transfer of pollen from the anther to the stigma on the same or a different flower	<i>Year 6: Plant life cycles</i>
6.6	understand the processes of insect and wind pollination	a simple description only: • bright coloured and scented flowers attract insects • insects brush against anther/pollen • sticky stigma takes pollen off insect • large filaments hang anthers outside flower so pollen is blown by the wind • large stigmas catch pollen. <i>Year 6: Plant life cycles</i>
6.7	know the parts of an insect-pollinated flower	these parts include sepal, petals, stamen (filament and anther), carpel (stigma, style, ovary and ova) <i>Year 6: Plant life cycles</i>
6.8	explain the function of the parts of an insect pollinated flower	<i>Year 6: Plant life cycles</i>
6.9	understand the terms <i>pollination</i> and <i>fertilisation</i>	pollination, the transfer of pollen from the anther to the stigma fertilisation occurs when the nucleus from the pollen combines with the nucleus in an ovule – detailed mechanism NOT required <i>Year 6: Plant life cycles</i>

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6.10	know different mechanisms by which seeds are dispersed	including: • water, for example coconut • wind, for example poppy, dandelion and sycamore seeds • animals, for example fruits, nuts and berries • explosion, for example peas and vetch. <i>Year 6: Plant life cycles</i>